



Privacy Policy

God Hub is committed to safeguarding you, including the personal information that you share with us. We want you to understand what information we hold, why we hold it and what we do with it.

This privacy policy explains how God Hub collects, uses and protects your personal information. We regularly review this policy and update it when our activities or the law changes.

Who we are:

God Hub is a Church located in Southwick, Sunderland.

For data protection purposes, God Hub is the data controller for the personal information described in this policy. This means that we are responsible for deciding how and why your personal information is used.

If you have any questions about how we use your information or would like to exercise any of your data protection rights, please talk to or message us.

What information do we collect?

The information we collect depends on how you are involved with God Hub. It may include:

- your name and contact details;
- your date of birth or age;
- information about your household or family;
- information about your involvement with God Hub, including groups, events, serving teams and rotas;

- your communication preferences;
- information relating to donations and Gift Aid;
- photographs or video;
- information you give us when asking for prayer, pastoral care or other support;
- information relating to safeguarding;
- information about children and young people where they participate in our activities; and
- technical information collected when you use our website.

We only collect information that we have a reason to use. We will not collect any information unnecessarily.

How do we get your information?

Most of the information we hold is provided directly by you. For example, you might give us information when you complete a form, attend an event, join a group, volunteer, make a donation or get in touch with us.

Sometimes information may be provided by someone else. For example, a parent or guardian may provide information about their child, or information may be shared with us where this is necessary for safeguarding or another legitimate reason.

Why do we use your information?

We use personal information so that we can be a church community and carry out our activities. This includes using information to:

- keep in touch with you;
- help you participate in the life of God Hub;
- organise services, groups, events and activities;
- organise serving teams and rotas;

- provide pastoral care and support;
- respond to prayer requests;
- support and safeguard children and adults;
- manage donations and Gift Aid;
- administer our team and volunteers;
- meet our legal, financial and regulatory responsibilities; and
- keep our people, spaces and systems safe and secure.

We will only use personal information where we have an appropriate reason and lawful basis for doing so.

Depending on what we are doing, our lawful basis may be that:

- you have given us your consent;
- it is necessary to fulfil an agreement or arrangement with you;
- we have a legal obligation;
- it is necessary to protect someone's vital interests; or
- we have a legitimate interest in using the information and that interest is not overridden by your rights and interests.

Where we rely on your consent, you can withdraw that consent at any time.

Sensitive information:

Some personal information is given additional protection under data protection law and is known as special category data.

Because God Hub is a Church, some of the information we hold may reveal someone's religious beliefs. We may also sometimes need to hold other sensitive information, such as information about someone's health or circumstances, particularly when providing pastoral care or safeguarding people.

We will only use this information where we have both an appropriate lawful basis and an additional legal condition allowing us to process special category information.

As a not-for-profit organisation with a religious purpose, the law allows us in certain circumstances to process information relating to our members, former members and people who have regular contact with us in connection with our purposes.

We may rely on other conditions where appropriate, for example where you have given explicit consent or where processing is necessary to protect someone's vital interests.

We take particular care over sensitive information and limit access to those who need it.

Children and young people:

Children and young people are an important part of God Hub and we take particular care with their personal information.

Where children or young people participate in our activities, we may collect information such as their name, age or date of birth, contact details, parent or guardian details, relevant medical or accessibility information, emergency contacts, attendance information and safeguarding information.

We use this information to run activities safely, communicate with parents and guardians where appropriate, and fulfil our safeguarding responsibilities.

We will only collect and use information about children and young people where we have an appropriate reason to do so, and access will be limited to those who need it.

ChurchSuite:

God Hub uses ChurchSuite as our main system for managing information about people who are part of, or interact with, our Church.

If you complete a form on our website, the information you provide may be stored in ChurchSuite.

ChurchSuite also allows you to view and update much of the information we hold about you.

Some information cannot be changed or deleted directly through ChurchSuite. We may need to retain certain information for legal, financial, safeguarding or other legitimate reasons.

Your data in ChurchSuite is only visible to you and our assigned admins.

Our current ChurchSuite Admins are:

- Nikki Main, Senior Church Leader.
- Samuel Main, Tech Lead.

If you have any queries about how we handle your information or how to use ChurchSuite, please talk to us or message us.

To sign in to ChurchSuite search for God Hub at <https://login.churchsuite.com/>

You can also read ChurchSuite's privacy notice.

<https://churchsuite.com/privacy-notice/>

WhatsApp:

God Hub uses WhatsApp to help us communicate with members of our community and encourage communication with one another.

If you choose to join our WhatsApp community, you will be using a service provided by WhatsApp and your use of that service is also subject to WhatsApp's own terms and privacy arrangements.

Joining our WhatsApp Community means that your telephone number will be visible to the Community Admins.

Our current Community Admins are:

- Nikki Main, Senior Church Leader.

If you join a group within the Community, your telephone number, username and/or profile information may also be visible to other members of that group, depending on your WhatsApp settings and the way WhatsApp operates its Community and group features.

You should therefore only join a God Hub WhatsApp group if you are comfortable with this information being visible to other group members.

You can leave a group or the Community at any time using WhatsApp.

Photographs, video and livestreaming:

We may take photographs or video at God Hub services, events and activities and may use these to communicate about the life of the Church, including on our website and social media.

We take particular care when using identifiable photographs or video of children and young people.

If you do not want yourself/a child you are responsible for to appear on social media or website, please ensure a member of team is notified as soon as possible.

Some of our services or events may also be livestreamed or recorded. Where this happens, we will take reasonable steps to make people aware and include space(s) where you can avoid being included in video.

If you have concerns about our video/photography please talk to us or message us.

Who do we share information with?

We use trusted organisations and services to help us operate God Hub. These may include organisations providing:

- church management systems;
- website and hosting services;
- email and communications;
- payment and donation processing; and
- IT and cloud services.

Where another organisation processes information on our behalf, we take appropriate steps to make sure that personal information is protected.

We may also share information where there is an appropriate reason to do so. For example, we may share information with HMRC in connection with Gift Aid.

We may share information with our safeguarding advisor
Thirtyone:Eight, the police, local authorities or other appropriate agencies where this is necessary to protect a child or adult, comply with the law or fulfil our safeguarding responsibilities.

We do not sell your personal information.

Keeping your information safe:

We take appropriate technical and organisational measures to protect the personal information we hold against loss, misuse, unauthorised access or disclosure.

Access to personal information is limited according to people's roles and responsibilities. Information of a particularly sensitive nature is subject to additional restrictions where appropriate.

However, no method of storing or transmitting information is completely risk-free.

How long do we keep your information?

We do not keep personal information indefinitely just because we might need it one day.

We keep information for as long as we reasonably need it for the purpose for which it was collected, and in accordance with our legal, financial, safeguarding and regulatory responsibilities.

Different types of information need to be kept for different lengths of time. For example, financial, Gift Aid and safeguarding information may need to be retained after someone's active involvement with God Hub has ended.

When information is no longer required, we will securely delete or anonymise it where appropriate.

Information stored outside the UK

Whilst we take steps to maintain UK data residency, some of the organisations and technology services we use may process or store information outside the UK.

Where personal information is transferred internationally, we will take appropriate steps to ensure that it continues to receive the protection required by UK data protection law.

Your rights

Data protection law gives you a number of rights over your personal information. Depending on the circumstances, these can include the right to:

- know how we use your information;
- ask us for a copy of the information we hold about you;
- ask us to correct inaccurate or incomplete information;
- ask us to delete information in certain circumstances;
- ask us to restrict how information is used in certain circumstances;
- object to certain uses of your information;
- receive certain information in a portable format; and
- withdraw your consent where we rely on consent to use your information.

These rights do not apply in exactly the same way in every situation. For example, we may sometimes be legally required to retain information even if you ask us to delete it.

If you would like to exercise one of these rights, please talk to us or message us.

We will not charge you for exercising your data protection rights in most circumstances.

If you have a concern

If you have any questions or concerns about how God Hub has used your personal information, please speak to us first. We want to put things right where we can.

You can contact us at our postal address:

God Hub
15 Gordon Terrace, Southwick, Sunderland, SR5 2DW

Or contact us:
Nikki@Godhub.church

You also have the right to raise a concern with the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO), the UK's independent regulator for data protection.

<https://ico.org.uk/>

Cookies and our website:

Our website may use cookies and similar technologies to make the site work, understand how it is being used and provide features from third-party services.

Where these are used, you will have the ability to change permissions and restrict their use.

Changes to this policy:

We will review this privacy policy regularly and update it where our activities, systems or legal responsibilities change.

We will publish the latest version on our website and, where a change significantly affects how we use your personal information, we will take reasonable steps to let you know.